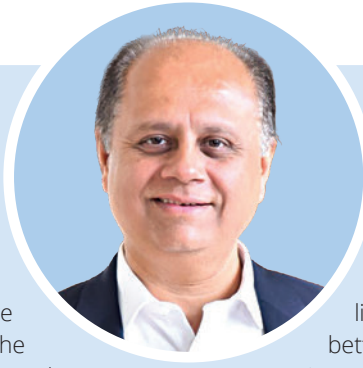


On-device AI rises

In 2026, the most defining shift in personal computing will be the emergence of hybrid AI architectures becoming mainstream. PCs will evolve into truly AI-native devices, where intelligence flows seamlessly between the cloud and powerful on-device capabilities. The one AI capability Indians won't be able to live without is an always-on, context-aware AI assistant that works



locally on the device as well as in the cloud. From summarising meetings and drafting content to personalising learning and automating everyday tasks, AI will act as a true productivity partner. Crucially, when this intelligence runs on-device, it also ensures better responsiveness, reliability, and data privacy, making AI not just powerful, but trustworthy for the future of work.

—VINEET GEHANI, SENIOR DIRECTOR - PERSONAL SYSTEMS, HP INDIA

Truly smart devices era

We believe the single biggest defining trend of personal computing in 2026 will be the transition from “smart devices” to truly intelligent companions. AI will no longer sit as a layer on top of the PC experience – it will become deeply embedded into how devices think, adapt, and respond to users in real time. Personal computing is shifting from being reactive to being intuitive. What

makes this shift defining is that intelligence is moving closer to the user. With more AI workloads happening directly on the device, users will experience faster performance, greater privacy, and far more personalization without depending on cloud.

—ASHISH SIKKA, DIRECTOR AND CATEGORY HEAD, LENOVO INDIA



LLMs on PCs

For us, the single biggest defining trend in personal computing in 2026 will be the rise of micro LLMs running directly on AI PCs. These are compact, highly efficient models purpose-built for specific tasks that live right on your device without requiring massive compute power. What's exciting is that this fundamentally changes how personal computing works; your AI PC isn't just an endpoint anymore, it's an active decision-maker right there with you. When models run locally, you get virtually instant responses with no lag, and your data stays on your device.

—INDRAJIT BELGUNDI, SENIOR DIRECTOR AND GENERAL MANAGER, CLIENT SOLUTIONS GROUP, DELL TECHNOLOGIES, INDIA



AI processing on device

At MSI, we believe the single biggest defining tech trend in personal computing for 2026 will be AI applications powered by edge computing. We're witnessing a pivotal shift where AI processing is moving from the cloud directly onto your device. This transformation is being driven by the emergence of Small Language Models (SLMs) that are

efficient enough to run locally on laptops and desktops, delivering powerful AI capabilities without relying on internet connectivity. What excites us most is how production software is being reimaged to leverage AI optimization at the hardware level. We're seeing a remarkable behavioral transformation where Indian consumers are turning to AI agents as their first port of call, often even before traditional search engines.

—BRUCE LIN, MARKETING MANAGER, SOUTH ASIA, MSI

